

SSA Application Assistance — Child Complete Worksheet

For parents and caregivers applying for SSI for a child under 18. Use it together with the steps in this packet to do the application yourself. If you need help, book a Zoom with us and we will guide you.

Southern Oak Financial & Wellness • southernoakfw.org

The big picture: For a child, the benefit is SSI (Supplemental Security Income). Social Security looks at two things: (1) your child's health condition and how it limits what your child can do each day, and (2) your household income and resources. Part of a parent's income counts for the child. This is called "deeming." A parent or caregiver applies. The child does not apply alone.

Your \$50 Complete Package — What You Get

- ☐ This complete worksheet, to fill in as you go
- ☐ Step-by-step ID.me setup — where to go, and the papers to have ready
- ☐ **Step-by-step help to do the application yourself.** Most of the questions on the application come from your intake answers — answer each question correctly. **Save the Reference # SSA gives you. That is how you get back in.** If you need help, book a Zoom appointment with us (30 minutes, \$26) and we will guide you. Email southernoakfw@gmail.com.

Part 1 — About Your Child and Family

Child's full name

Child's date of birth

Child's Social Security number

Diagnoses / conditions

Parent / caregiver applying

Relationship to child

Household income (monthly)

Other benefits in the home

Part 2 — Documents Checklist

- ☐ Child's birth certificate and Social Security card

- ☐ Proof of the child's citizenship or legal status
- ☐ Parent's photo ID
- ☐ Proof of household income — pay stubs, benefits letters (deeming information)
- ☐ Bank statements and resource information for the household
- ☐ Medical records — every doctor, hospital, clinic, and therapist, with dates
- ☐ Medication list — name, dose, who prescribed it, and why
- ☐ School records — IEPs, 504 plans, report cards, testing and evaluations
- ☐ Teacher statements about how your child functions at school
- ☐ Therapy records — OT, PT, speech, ABA, behavioral health
- ☐ Names and contact information for people who see your child's daily struggles

Part 3 — How to Apply, Step by Step

Step 1 — Protect your filing date. Start right away: begin online at ssa.gov (child disability report), or call 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 1-800-325-0778) to start the SSI claim and schedule the interview. Payments can only go back so far — starting early protects money your child may be owed.

Step 2 — Complete the Child Disability Report. List every condition, every provider, and every medicine. Do not leave anything out — combine all conditions, because Social Security must consider them together.

Step 3 — Do the SSI interview. Social Security will ask about household income, resources, and living arrangements. Answer honestly and fully. Ask what papers they still need.

Step 4 — Turn in records fast. Send school and medical records as soon as you can. Ask the school in writing for complete records, and keep a copy of everything you send.

Step 5 — The exam (if SSA sets one up). Social Security may send your child to an exam with their doctor. **SSA covers the cost of that exam — you do not pay for it.** Just follow the instructions in SSA's letter on what to take to the appointment. Go, be on time, and tell that doctor the same honest story you told Social Security.

Step 6 — The decision. If approved, payments begin and Medicaid usually follows in Texas. If denied, you generally have 60 days to appeal — reconsideration first, then a hearing. Many child cases are approved on appeal with full school and medical records. If you are denied, email us right away — see “If You Are Denied” in Part 5 below.

The Remarks Box — What to Write

Near the end of the online application, Social Security gives you a box called **Remarks**. There is no question in it. It is an open box for **extra information — anything you want to add, or anything that did not fit in the other parts**. If it does not all fit, SSA says to write it on a separate sheet of paper. Mail it to the address they give you at the end of the application.

Use the Remarks box for:

- ☐ Extra doctors, hospitals, clinics, or therapists that did not fit in the medical sections

- ☐ Extra conditions, or more detail about a condition
- ☐ How your child's condition limits daily life — school, learning, playing, and getting along with others — in real examples
- ☐ Hospital or ER visits, and medication side effects
- ☐ When things started, and anything that has changed since then
- ☐ A note if you are mailing records or forms separately, so SSA knows they are coming

Draft your remarks here first — plain words and real examples help the most:

Do not leave the Remarks box blank if there is anything extra Social Security should know. It is the one place in the application where you can explain things in your own words.

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Part 4 — The Six Areas of Functioning (Your Evidence Worksheet)

For a child, Social Security looks at six areas of daily life. (SSA calls them “domains.”) Your child must show a marked limit in two areas, or an extreme limit in one area. Under each area, write real examples from daily life. Write what happens, how often, and what help your child needs, compared with other children the same age.

1. Acquiring and Using Information — learning, reading, math, understanding and remembering schoolwork

2. Attending and Completing Tasks — focus, finishing homework and chores, rushing, giving up, needing reminders

3. Interacting and Relating With Others — speech and language, making friends, behavior with adults and children

4. Moving About and Manipulating Objects — walking, balance, hand skills, coordination, physical limits

5. Caring for Yourself — dressing, bathing, eating, safety awareness, handling feelings and behavior

6. Health and Physical Well-Being — illnesses, episodes, medication side effects, tiredness, hospital visits

Part 5 — After You Apply

- ☐ Keep medical and therapy care going — gaps in treatment can hurt the claim
- ☐ Tell Social Security about new diagnoses, hospital visits, or school changes
- ☐ Open every letter the day it arrives and write every deadline on a calendar
- ☐ Keep copies of everything — applications, letters, and your notes from every call

☐ Plan ahead for age 18: SSI is decided again under adult rules (see the Adult Complete Worksheet)

If You Are Denied — Get Connected

If you are denied — do not let the deadline pass. Email us the same week at southernoakfw@gmail.com. You generally have only 60 days to appeal, so do not let that deadline go by. We will connect you with special needs attorneys who can further help you more with your case. The attorney does not charge an upfront fee — they are paid only if you win.

Please read: This worksheet is an educational tool only. It is not legal, tax, medical, or financial advice, and Southern Oak Financial & Wellness is not a law firm and does not provide legal representation. Social Security rules change — confirm current details at ssa.gov or with Social Security before you act. There is no guarantee of approval for any benefit: only the Social Security Administration decides claims. Timelines are common ranges, not promises. This worksheet is for your family's personal use only — no refunds.

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